

The Head of the Center for Interreligious and Intercultural Dialogue Meets with the Armenian Delegation

In his meeting with the Rector of the Yerevan State University and the accompanying delegation, Dr. Ziaei emphasized interreligious dialogue as a platform for promoting peace and coexistence in the world and an effective means for the elimination of extremism.

Dr. Hovhannes Hovhannisyan, the Rector of the Yerevan State University, which has, at the head of a delegation consisting of vice-rectors and deans of faculties and chairs of Iranian studies of this university paid a visit to Iran, met with Dr. Ali Akbar Ziaei, the head of the Center for Interreligious and Intercultural Dialogue in the Islamic Culture and Relations Organization and exchanged views.

Referring to interreligious dialogue as a platform for promoting peace and coexistence and elimination of extremism, Dr. Ziaei added that we are of the opinion that interreligious dialogue can stimulate synergy and peaceful coexistence among the followers of religions and any effort in this regard would be a great service to the human world. Ziaei also stated that according to religious teachings, coexistence among the followers of divine and Eastern religions can take place only through dialogue and synergy.

Referring to the profound cultural ties between Iran and Armenia, the head of the Center for the Interreligious and Intercultural Dialogue added: "We believe in better understanding, cooperation, and interaction among religions, and we hope to take serious and important steps in this regard."

Dr. Ziaei also called for the expansion of dialogue between the academic elites of the two countries and said: "We are prepared to cooperate in various academic fields such as establishing a chair of Islamic studies in Armenia, exchanging professors and students, granting sabbaticals and scholarships, and organizing interreligious dialogue."

Expressing satisfaction about their trip to Iran and thanking the cultural officials of the Islamic Republic of Iran for their hospitality, Dr. Hovhannes Hovhannisyan, the Rector of the Yerevan State University, too, emphasized the preparedness of his university to expand relations with Iran and said: "In today's turbulent world, we need interreligious dialogue for the establishment of peace and stability in the world."

Emphasizing the importance of strengthening dialogue between Islam and Christianity, Hovhannisyan added: while reflecting upon the position of spirituality, dialogues between religions can result in better understanding among the religious leaders and thinkers."

The Rector of the Yerevan State University further stated: "We believe that holding interreligious dialogues will awaken the new generation to get to know each other well enough and be able to speak a common language."

Referring to the historical and cultural interactions between Iran and Armenia, he stated: "In addition to racial kinship, Iranians and Armenians have many cultural commonalities that are the outcome of their being neighbors."

Dr. Hovhannisyan also stressed the need for the promotion of bilateral cultural discourses and added: "The Faculty of Oriental Studies of Yerevan State University has a chair of Iranian Studies, which indicates the antiquity of cultural relations between the two countries."

He concluded by pointing out to the establishment of the Department of Islamic Studies at Yerevan State University and stating that this move was the point of departure for cooperation between Iran and Armenia in the field of Islamic research, which will play a significant role in strengthening friendship and relations between the two.